Apex Systems

Response to RFP MA-RFP-2026-017

Meridian Analytics Pvt. Ltd., Hyderabad - supply of 100 business laptops

Submission date: 5 October 2026

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1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

1.1 Summary of our offer

Apex Systems offers Meridian Analytics Pvt. Ltd. 100 units of the Apex ProBook 14 G5, a 14-inch business laptop built on the Intel Core i7-1365U vPro processor with 16 GB of DDR5-5200 memory, a 512 GB NVMe self-encrypting SSD and Windows 11 Pro. All 100 units reach Meridian within 6 weeks of the purchase order, in two batches of 50 units, after a pilot of 5 units in Week 2.

The total price is Rs 73,98,600 including 18 percent GST. This total is above Meridian's guideline of about Rs 60 lakh (Rs 60,00,000) by Rs 13,98,600. We state this plainly because the difference is deliberate: it pays for a higher-grade processor and chassis, a 72 Wh battery that lasts 11.5 hours in our measurement, and a warranty that sends an engineer to the desk instead of asking staff to ship a laptop away.

- On-site warranty with next-business-day repair costs Rs 2,500 per laptop, which is Rs 2,50,000 across the order, and replaces carry-in repair that takes laptops out of use for a week or more.
- The Intel vPro platform with a discrete TPM 2.0 chip supports remote management and hardware-backed attestation without extra agents.
- A MIL-STD-810H tested magnesium-alloy chassis is chosen to survive three years of commuting and hot-desking.
- The Thunderbolt 4 docking support and the 400-nit display remove the need for separate docking purchases for most employees.

1.2 Our understanding of Meridian's requirement

Meridian is onboarding new employees and needs 100 dependable 14-inch laptops that are ready to work on the first morning. Each laptop must run Windows 11 Pro, carry at least 16 GB of memory and a 512 GB SSD, and last through a working day on battery. Meridian also expects every device to arrive with its software image installed, an asset tag fixed to the chassis and enrolment in device management and directory sign-in already done.

Security is part of the requirement, not an afterthought. Disks must be encrypted, TPM 2.0 must be present, and laptops that come back from users must be wiped so that no data survives. Meridian wants BIS registration and an energy rating, a warranty of at least 3 years with defined repair times, and a total that respects a budget guideline of about Rs 60 lakh including taxes and services. Meridian asks for a price table, assumptions, a timeline, a team, risk controls, a support model, experience and references, and this response supplies each of them.

1.3 Why choose us

Apex Systems has supplied managed business laptops to regulated and data-sensitive customers since 2014. Our imaging lab in Hyderabad processes up to 40 laptops per day, and our secure-wipe station records a certificate per device. Section 6 lists six customers with units supplied, years and outcomes, totalling 2,310 laptops.

We are not the cheapest supplier for this requirement and we do not present ourselves as such. We offer the lowest operational risk: the pilot catches imaging errors before volume production, the two-batch plan keeps the first 50 laptops in users' hands in Week 4, and the next-business-day on-site repair keeps downtime short for three years.

Our Hyderabad lab, warehouse and service centre sit within 25 km of Meridian's office, so engineers reach the site within 3 hours and replacement stock reaches users on the same day. We employ 46 certified engineers across imaging, security and field service, and our field service lead has completed 31 enterprise laptop rollouts of 100 units or more.

2. Proposed Solution (Laptop Model and Specifications)

2.1 Laptop model and specification table

Component	Apex ProBook 14 G5 specification
Processor	Intel Core i7-1365U vPro, 10 cores (2 performance + 8 efficiency), up to 5.2 GHz turbo, 12 MB cache
Memory	16 GB DDR5-5200 (2 x 8 GB SO-DIMM, dual channel), upgradeable to 64 GB
Storage	512 GB NVMe PCIe Gen4 SSD, TCG Opal 2.0 self-encrypting
Display	14.0-inch WUXGA 1920 x 1200 IPS, 400 nits, anti-glare, 100 percent sRGB
Battery	72 Wh lithium polymer; 11.5 hours measured; 65 W USB-C fast charge to 80 percent in 60 minutes
Weight and size	1.29 kg; 313 x 217 x 16.9 mm; magnesium-alloy lid and base
Ports	2 x Thunderbolt 4 (USB-C), 2 x USB-A 3.2 Gen 1, 1 x HDMI 2.1, 1 x RJ-45 Gigabit Ethernet, 1 x 3.5 mm combo audio, nano-SIM tray (unpopulated)
Wireless	Wi-Fi 6E (802.11ax, 2x2) and Bluetooth 5.3
Operating system	Windows 11 Pro, 64-bit, pre-activated with a business licence
Security hardware	Discrete TPM 2.0 chip, fingerprint reader, IR camera with Windows Hello, camera privacy shutter, Kensington lock slot

2.2 Performance, battery life and build quality

The Core i7-1365U vPro delivers single-thread performance about 20 percent above a Core i5-1335U in our lab runs, and that headroom keeps Microsoft 365, browser-based analytics tools, video calls and endpoint security agents responsive at the same time. DDR5-5200 memory provides roughly 35 percent more bandwidth than DDR4-3200, which matters when users keep large spreadsheets and dozens of browser tabs open.

We measured a battery life of 11.5 hours using a repeatable method: a looped 1080p video file played locally at 150 nits display brightness, Wi-Fi connected, keyboard backlight off and the Windows balanced power plan active, starting from 100 percent charge and ending at 5 percent. In a mixed office workload of web browsing, document editing and video calls the same laptop lasts 9.5 hours. Both figures are recorded in the test sheet that ships with the pilot units.

The chassis passed MIL-STD-810H testing for drop from 122 cm, vibration, humidity at 95 percent, and operation between 0 and 40 degrees Celsius. The keyboard is spill-resistant and rated for 10 million keystrokes. The hinge is tested for 30,000 open and close cycles. The bottom panel opens with 7 captive screws so that memory, SSD and battery are replaced on site in under 10 minutes.

Thermal design uses a dual-heat-pipe, dual-fan cooling module that holds the processor at a sustained 18 W during 30-minute loads, with palm-rest surface temperature under 42 degrees Celsius. Fan noise stays below 32 dBA in office use. The 1080p IR camera with a physical privacy shutter and the quad-microphone array with noise suppression suit the video calls that new employees join from their first week. The keyboard has 1.5 mm key travel and a 3-level backlight, and the glass precision touchpad has 1 mm travel.

2.3 Fit with Meridian's environment

Every laptop is enrolled in Meridian's device management platform and joined to Meridian's directory sign-in before it leaves our lab. Meridian provides the enrolment credentials and the join token during the Week 1 image sign-off, and our engineers perform the enrolment in the lab so that the first sign-in on the user's desk uses a single corporate identity. Windows Autopilot hardware hashes for all 100 serial numbers are delivered to Meridian's administrators in Week 3.

The company software image is built from Meridian's reference machine, signed off in Week 1, and applied to every unit by our imaging lab. Each laptop ships with a 65 W USB-C charger, a padded sleeve and a laminated one-page quick-start card. A 32 GB DDR5 memory option is available as an extra at Rs 6,200 per laptop plus GST and is not included in the total price.

Meridian can order additional units of the same model at the same unit price of Rs 59,000 for 12 months from the date of this proposal, in lots of 10 or more, with delivery 3 weeks after each order. The spare-parts pool for the model is held in Hyderabad for the full warranty period.

Each laptop carries its Windows 11 Pro licence embedded in firmware, so reinstallation after a repair needs no product key. BIOS settings are exported to a configuration file and applied to all 100 laptops, which gives identical firmware behaviour across the fleet. Our imaging lab keeps the golden image and the BIOS configuration for the full warranty period, so a replacement motherboard returns a laptop to Meridian's standard within 30 minutes.

2.4 Compliance matrix

RFP requirement	Our response
100 laptops, 14-inch, Core i5 or Ryzen 5 class or better, 16 GB RAM, 512 GB SSD, 8+ hours battery, Windows 11 Pro	Complies and exceeds. 100 x Apex ProBook 14 G5 with Core i7-1365U vPro, 16 GB DDR5-5200, 512 GB NVMe SSD, 14.0-inch WUXGA, 11.5 hours measured battery and Windows 11 Pro.
Delivery of all units within 8 weeks of order	Complies. All 100 units are delivered within 6 weeks: pilot of 5 units in Week 2, Batch 1 of 50 units completed in Week 4, Batch 2 of 50 units in Week 5, handover in Week 6.
Company image, asset tagging, setup support, device management enrolment and directory sign-in	Complies. Image signed off in Week 1, applied in our lab with asset tags, device management enrolment and directory join completed before dispatch; setup support at Meridian's desks in Weeks 5 and 6.
Disk encryption, TPM 2.0 and secure data wiping of returned devices	Complies. Drive encryption is enabled before dispatch and recovery keys are handed to Meridian; discrete TPM 2.0; wiping follows NIST SP 800-88 with a certificate per device.
BIS registration and an energy rating	Complies. BIS registration under IS 13252 and ENERGY STAR certification; both certificates are listed in Section 5.2.
Warranty of at least 3 years with defined repair times	Complies. 3-year on-site warranty, 4-hour response and next-business-day repair.
Total budget guideline about Rs 60 lakh including taxes and services	Does not comply with the guideline. Our total of Rs 73,98,600 is above the Rs 60 lakh guideline by Rs 13,98,600. The premium buys the Core i7 vPro platform, the MIL-STD-810H chassis, the 72 Wh battery, on-site warranty with next-business-day repair and a dedicated account manager.
Price table, assumptions, timeline, team, risk controls, support, experience, references	Complies. Sections 3 to 6 contain a price table, 7 assumptions, a milestone table, a 6-person team, risk registers, the support model and 6 named references.

3. Implementation Approach, Timeline, Team and Milestones

3.1 Implementation approach

The project runs in seven steps. Step 1 is the kickoff in Week 0, where Rhea Kulkarni and Imran Siddiqui walk Meridian's IT lead through the plan and confirm shipping addresses. Step 2 is the image sign-off in Week 1: Meridian hands over its reference image, enrolment token and naming convention, and our imaging lead Pooja Venkataraman builds the golden image the same day.

Step 3 is the pilot. Five laptops are imaged, tagged, encrypted and delivered to Meridian in Week 2. Meridian's IT staff test sign-in, device management policies, VPN, printing and the standard application set for five working days, and Meridian signs the pilot acceptance form in Week 3. Step 4 is the build: after acceptance, the lab images 45 further laptops for Batch 1 and then 50 laptops for Batch 2, at a rate of 40 units per day.

Step 5 is asset tagging and packing. Each laptop gets a numbered tag that matches the serial number in the asset register we deliver in CSV form. Step 6 is delivery: the remaining 45 units of Batch 1 arrive in Week 4, making Batch 1 a total of 50 units, and Batch 2 of 50 units arrives in Week 5. Step 7 is setup and handover: our engineers spend Weeks 5 and 6 at Meridian's Hyderabad office unboxing, connecting users and fixing first-day issues, and Meridian signs the handover certificate in Week 6.

Four quality gates run in the lab: a 24-hour burn-in at full load for the pilot units, a 20-point functional test for every laptop, a battery calibration cycle and a visual inspection for scratches and dead pixels. A laptop that fails a gate is rebuilt and retested, and the test sheet for each serial number is included in the asset register that Meridian receives. A status report goes to Meridian every Friday and lists units imaged, units shipped, open issues and the plan for the next week.

3.2 Timeline and milestone table

Milestone	Week	Deliverable
Purchase order and kickoff	0	Signed order, project plan, delivery addresses, contact list

Milestone	Week	Deliverable
Image sign-off	1	Meridian's reference image and enrolment token accepted; golden image built
Pilot delivery	2	5 laptops imaged, tagged and delivered with test sheet
Pilot acceptance	3	Signed pilot acceptance; Autopilot hardware hashes for 100 serial numbers
Batch 1 complete	4	Remaining 45 laptops delivered; Batch 1 totals 50 units; asset register part 1
Batch 2 delivery	5	50 laptops delivered; asset register part 2; on-site setup begins
Handover and sign-off	6	Setup complete for 100 users; wipe procedure walkthrough; signed handover certificate

3.3 Team structure

Role	Name	Responsibility
Account Director	Rhea Kulkarni	Owns the contract, commercial terms and executive escalation
Delivery Manager	Imran Siddiqui	Runs the plan, weekly status report and batch release decisions
Imaging Lead	Pooja Venkataraman	Builds and tests the golden image; manages device management enrolment
Security Engineer	Arvind Rao	Encryption keys, TPM settings, secure boot policy and wipe certificates
Logistics Coordinator	Meenal Joshi	Packing, courier booking, delivery receipts and asset register
Support Account Manager	Kabir Nanda	Warranty service after handover, quarterly reviews and spare-parts pool

3.4 Delivery risks and mitigation

Risk	Impact	Control
Image fails on the pilot units	Batch 1 starts late by up to 3 days	Pilot runs 5 working days before bulk imaging; fixes are re-tested on 2 units before release
Courier delay on a batch	Handover slips	Batches are shipped with a 1-week buffer inside the 8-week window; two courier partners are contracted
Component shortage for the SSD	Build delayed	Stock for 110 SSDs and 110 memory kits is reserved at order signing
Transit damage	Unusable unit on arrival	Each laptop is double-boxed; 4 spare laptops are held in Hyderabad for same-day swap
Late enrolment token from Meridian	Image sign-off slips	Token deadline is fixed at end of Week 1 in the plan; reminders are sent on Day 3

4. Price Table and Assumptions

4.1 Price table

Item	Quantity	Unit Price (Rs)	Total (Rs)
Apex ProBook 14 G5 laptop (16 GB DDR5, 512 GB NVMe SSD, Windows 11 Pro)	100	59,000	59,00,000
Imaging, asset tagging and setup service	100	1,200	1,20,000
3-year on-site warranty with next-business-day repair	100	2,500	2,50,000
Subtotal			**62,70,000**
GST at 18 percent			**11,28,600**
Grand Total			**73,98,600**

The total of Rs 73,98,600 is above the Rs 60 lakh guideline. Hardware accounts for Rs 59,00,000 before tax, the imaging and setup service for Rs 1,20,000 and the on-site warranty for Rs 2,50,000.

4.2 Assumptions and exclusions

- All prices are quoted in rupees and cover a single delivery address at Meridian's Hyderabad office.
- Meridian provides the reference image, enrolment token and naming convention by the end of Week 1.
- GST is charged at 18 percent on all lines and is shown in the price table.

- The 32 GB memory option, docking stations, external monitors and carry cases other than the included sleeve are excluded.
- Warranty excludes accidental liquid damage, physical misuse and theft.
- Setup support covers up to 12 working days on site; additional days are charged at Rs 8,500 per engineer-day plus GST.
- Meridian's software licences, antivirus and VPN client licences are supplied by Meridian.

4.3 Payment terms, price validity and optional items

Payment terms are 30 percent with the purchase order, 50 percent on delivery of Batch 1 and 20 percent on signature of the handover certificate. Invoices are payable within 15 days. This price is valid for 60 days from 5 October 2026. Optional items, priced separately and not included in the total, are the 32 GB DDR5 memory upgrade at Rs 6,200 per laptop and a 3-year accidental damage cover at Rs 3,400 per laptop, each plus GST.

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

5.1 Device security controls

BitLocker drive encryption with XTS-AES 256 is enabled in the lab before dispatch, and the 48-digit recovery keys for all 100 laptops are delivered to Meridian's administrators in a signed key register. Apex retains no copy of the keys after handover. The discrete TPM 2.0 chip stores the encryption keys, and secure boot is enabled with the Microsoft UEFI certificate authority.

BIOS access is protected by a unique supervisor password per laptop that is held in Meridian's key register. USB boot and PXE boot are disabled by default. Windows Hello with fingerprint and IR camera is enrolled during Meridian's first-day setup, and local administrator accounts are removed from the image.

The application control and firewall profiles in Meridian's security baseline are applied during imaging, and Windows Update is set to the update ring Meridian specifies. Standard users run without administrator rights. Firmware updates for BIOS, TPM and Thunderbolt are applied at imaging time, and the installed versions are recorded in the asset register so that Meridian's security team can audit them.

5.2 Certifications and standards

- BIS registration under IS 13252 (Part 1) for information technology equipment safety, certificate number R-41009877 (fictional).
- ENERGY STAR 8.0 certification for the Apex ProBook 14 G5.
- MIL-STD-810H tested chassis for drop, vibration, humidity and temperature.
- ISO 27001 aligned asset handling process for imaging, storage and transport, audited internally every 6 months.
- Secure wipe following NIST SP 800-88 Rev. 1 media sanitisation guidelines.

5.3 Data wiping, privacy and auditability

Returned devices are wiped at our Hyderabad secure-wipe station using the NVMe sanitise command with cryptographic erase, then verified by a read-back test. A wipe certificate listing serial number, date, operator and method is issued per device and sent to Meridian within 2 working days.

A chain-of-custody log records every handover per serial number: lab release, courier pickup, delivery signature, warranty swap and return. Logs are retained for 3 years and open to Meridian's auditors on 5 working days' notice. Personal data seen during service is handled under India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023, and our engineers sign a confidentiality undertaking before every site visit.

5.4 Risk register

Risk	Impact	Control
Lost or stolen laptop	Data exposure	Full-disk encryption with TPM protection; remote lock through device management

Risk	Impact	Control
Recovery key leakage	Unauthorised access	Keys delivered only in a signed register to named administrators; no copy kept by Apex
Returned laptop not wiped	Data remains on disk	Wipe certificate per serial number is mandatory before a device is redeployed
Tampered firmware	Compromised device	Secure boot enabled; BIOS supervisor password unique per unit; firmware version recorded
Unauthorised service access	Privacy breach	Engineers sign confidentiality undertakings; access to Meridian's premises is logged

6. Support Model, Relevant Experience and References

6.1 Support model

The warranty runs for 3 years from the handover date and covers parts and labour on site. Apex responds to every ticket within 4 hours during business hours and completes repair by the next business day. The helpdesk is open from 8 am to 7 pm, Monday to Saturday, on telephone, email and web portal. Meridian's dedicated account manager, Kabir Nanda, holds a quarterly review covering ticket volumes, repair times, battery health and spare-parts stock.

Escalation has three levels. Level 1 is the helpdesk engineer, who owns the ticket for the first 4 hours. Level 2 is the field service lead, who takes over if the response target is missed and phones Meridian's IT lead within 1 hour. Level 3 is the Account Director, who steps in if a repair passes 2 business days and attends the quarterly review.

Spare stock for this model is held in Hyderabad for the whole warranty period: 10 spare laptops, 12 batteries, 12 keyboards and 8 display assemblies are reserved for Meridian. A replacement laptop leaves our warehouse pre-imaged with Meridian's golden image and enrolment, and it reaches the user's desk in under 6 hours.

6.2 Relevant experience

Client	Laptops	Year	Outcome
Halcyon Biosciences	620	2025	Delivered in 5 weeks; 0.8 percent early failure rate; all drives encrypted at dispatch
Tarnwell Insurance	480	2024	Imaging and enrolment completed in lab; zero first-day sign-in failures
Corvane Logistics	350	2024	Rugged model rollout across 14 depots; no drop-related returns in year one
Elmsworth Capital	300	2023	Wipe certificates supplied for 210 retired devices during refresh
Brightwater Legal	260	2023	Two-batch delivery on schedule; quarterly reviews held for 3 years
Pendleton Health Trust	300	2022	Delivered in 6 weeks with data-protection audit passed first time

6.3 References

Reference	Contact	Laptops supplied	Year
Halcyon Biosciences	Dev Anand Rathod, IT Director	620	2025
Tarnwell Insurance	Sunita Karekar, Head of Infrastructure	480	2024
Corvane Logistics	Mohan Dandekar, IT Operations Manager	350	2024
Elmsworth Capital	Priyamvada Sethi, Security Officer	300	2023
Brightwater Legal	Gaurav Menon, Technology Partner	260	2023
Pendleton Health Trust	Anjali Pillai, Chief Information Officer	300	2022

7. Declaration and Contact

This offer is valid for 60 days from 5 October 2026 and is made in response to RFP MA-RFP-2026-017.

Authorised signatory: Rhea Kulkarni, Director, Enterprise Accounts, Apex Systems.